

You're not safe until you've read this

If you look at some of the hacks and leaks of recent times – the scale for some of them and the nature of the data in others – the popular saying that privacy is a myth in the 21st century won't seem too unbelievable. Be it leaked celebrity photos or corporate data, in each of these cases the effect has always been disastrous for the ones who were hacked. These hacks and attacks were carried out under the effective guise of anonymity that the internet provides. As an unfortunate consequence, the only way you can protect yourself against such threats is by securing yourself.

Security itself is often overlooked and left to the experts. PC users leave it to their antivirus, website owners leave it to their CMS managers, a cloud users trusts the cloud provider and so on. Do you know that on average, about 37,000 websites are hacked every day in some form? And more than a 100 billion USD is spent every year to combat cybercrime?

The interesting bit is – it's not always the hackers fault – it's yours! Of course, what they are doing is illegal and with malicious intent. But do you really think that's going to change? On the other hand, the absence of some basic security measures, or some silly oversights, make their work even easier. Some estimates suggest, it takes only 10 minutes to crack a lowercase password that is six characters long. Add two extra letters and a few uppercase characters and that now it takes three years. Adding one character to that and some numbers, symbols and the result will take 44,530 years to crack.